promotion of morality.'[49] This led him to consider ways of succeeding where his predecessors had failed: namely, by issuing public proclamations and instructions, and giving muscle and teeth to his administration. He sees this innovation as being responsible for his success, and presumably desiring emulation by future rulers considers it necessary to explain how he came to evolve such a policy:

> How then might men (be made to) conform to (morality)?
>
> How might men (be made to) progress by an adequate promotion of morality?
>
> How could I elevate them by the promotion of morality?
>
> Concerning this, king Devanampriya Priyadarsin speaks thus.
>
> The following occurred to me.
>
> I shall use proclamations on morality, (and) shall order instruction in morality (to be given).
>
> Hearing this, men will conform to (it), will be elevated, and will (be made to) progress considerably by the proclamation of morality.
>
> For this purpose proclamations of morality were issued by me, (and) manifold instructions in morality were ordered (to be given), [in order that those agents] (of mine) too, who are occupied with many people, (and who) will exhort (them) and will explain (morality to them) in detail.[50]

A range of officials, from rajukkas to dharma-mahamatras, who figure in his earlier messages, are again mentioned; trees that he planted and wells dug on his orders also figure here—banyan trees for shade to cattle and men, and mango groves. The concern with the ordinary is extraordinary.

New also is the description of the ways in which his officials were occupied with the delivery of gifts and charities by him and his larger family. The recipients of charity were in Pataliputra and the provinces, and their 'dana' promoted morality. We know that donations were indeed made by his family, this being suggested by what is known as the Queen's Edict on the Allahabad pillar.

> At the word of Devanampriya, the Mahamatras everywhere have to be told (this).
>
> What gifts (have been made) here by the second queen, (viz.) either mango-groves, or gardens, or alms-houses, or whatever else, these (shall) be registered (in the name) of that queen.